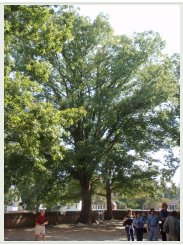
White Oak

Quercus alba

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Mirror Garden: 1 Passage: 1 **TOTAL 2**



Summer / form
Library candidate



Fall color
Library candidate

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 60–100 ft. Confirmed by UF/IFAS, Oregon State, NC State (range 60–80 ft to 60–100 ft). × 50–80 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 3–8/9. Native to eastern North America including Georgia. Performs in Atlanta. Long-lived. Slow growing. Prefers deep, moist, acidic soil. Reliable red fall color in Zone 8a. Difficult to transplant. Requires ample space. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State and regional sources confirm long-lived native oak for the Southeast. Existing notes stand.
Sun: Full sun. Tolerates light shade when young.
Water: Medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil. Moderately drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Deep, moist, well-drained, acidic preferred. Adaptable but best in fertile loam.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in deep, moist, acidic, well-drained soil. Water regularly until established. Difficult to transplant — plant young. Requires ample space. Slow growing. Suitable as large shade or specimen tree. Minimal pruning. Long-lived.
Soil prep: Deep, moist, well-drained, acidic preferred. Adaptable but best in fertile loam.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Native to eastern forests from Maine to Florida and west to Minnesota and Texas. Prefers well-drained uplands.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Large tree. Pyramidal when young, becoming broad rounded with wide-spreading branches. Slow growth. Long-lived.
Foliage: Red to reddish-purple (reliable in Zone 8a). Leaves may persist into winter. Secondary Atlanta/Georgia sources (EastLake, GNPS, UF/IFAS) confirm wine-red or purple, often reliable and outstanding among oaks in Zone 8a and colder.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Light gray, scaly, flaky plates.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Possible oak wilt, leaf issues, or other oak pests. Generally long-lived and durable. Difficult to establish. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Rounded-lobed leaves (no bristles). - Reliable red fall color. - Light gray scaly bark. - Long-lived (hundreds of years possible). - Slow growth. - Valuable timber and wildlife tree.